

THOMAS HIGSON

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TomHigson

Introduction

I'm a senior product manager with over **18 years' experience** developing technology, including **8 years in product leadership**.

I specialise in **product strategy** and have a proven record of bringing novel products from concept to production to bring data-backed value.

My core strength is in **building trust-based relationships** that enable teams to approach difficult, open ended problems with creativity, to transform visionary ideas into successful products.

Proficiencies

Frameworks

- **Agile** (Scrum, Scrumban, and Kanban)
- Lean
- SAFe

Domains

- **Software as a Service**
- **Machine learning**
- User experience
- Cloud platforms

Tools

- Miro
- Jira
- Confluence
- Aha
- Amplitude
- Delighted

Technology

- Cloud infrastructure
- REST APIs

Qualifications

- **1st class B.Sc. in Computer Science**
- PMI Agile Certified Practitioner
- Google Cloud Digital Leader
- Machine Learning Crash Course
- Managing ML Projects
- Mental health first aider



Career



Senior Product Manager

[Tesco](#)

4 years

January 2022 – Current

As one of the first product managers in Tesco's infrastructure group, I've worked to **introduce and champion agile and product management practices**. I used these to investigate new product opportunities, resulting in the creation of several new products. My highlights include:

- **I line managed a new team of 7 engineers** to take a new platform from idea to production. As the infrastructure group's first managed platform, we had to **make a business case for platform engineering, align large sets of diverse stakeholders**, drive excitement with a concept vision, and **keep stakeholders involved** throughout delivery.
- **I led the product strategy** for another new platform that enables internal teams to deploy, manage, and monitor diverse edge workloads at massive scale across 5000 locations. My work enabled 3,000 engineers to focus on building innovative applications by providing them with highly available, performant, and cost-effective infrastructure.
- **I led discovery workshops and working groups** to establish new ways of working for 300 people, resulting in a new set of operating principles and processes. **This required influencing without authority and compromising effectively** between diverse stakeholders.
- **I mentored 3 new product managers** to help them develop skills including problem discovery, product market fit, backlog prioritisation, and influencing.
- **I introduced and led learning initiatives** such as product show-and-tell, book clubs, and work shadowing.



Product Manager

[Ocado Technology](#)

1 year, 10 months

March 2020 – January 2022

I managed the search and discovery capabilities for Ocado's next-generation e-commerce platform.

- **I led a strategy** to increase product discoverability, resulting in increased customer satisfaction and reduced waste.
- **I built a diverse, multidisciplinary team** through internal movements and recruiting new talent.
- I led work to optimise a recommendation engine and the associated use cases, driving a **3x increase in key use case uptake**.

- I used **value stream analysis** to define the warehouse automation roadmap.



Technical Product Owner

6 months

[Dyson](#)

September 2018 – March 2020

I managed Dyson's cloud architecture product strategy, ensuring critical e-commerce services were performant and scalable for the 2019 peak trading season. I assessed and allocated work across nine scrum teams to identify and resolve performance bottlenecks.

- I line managed 3 technical product managers.
- Together, we delivered **100% uptime** during the peak trading window, a first for the company.
- I introduced an accounting framework into the engineering process to drive cost accountability, resulting in a **50% reduction in idle cloud resource costs**.
- I successfully transitioned the identity management system from a monolithic, unsupported system to modern architecture, resolving long-standing scalability issues.



Product Owner

2 years

[General Dynamics](#)

September 2017 – September 2019

I built and led a research and development team to solve critical platform challenges for the Ministry of Defence. My work focused on modernizing the UK Army's approach to deploying applications onto distributed networks, a traditionally slow and costly process. We enabled the organization to adopt modern, agile practices and collaborate more effectively with wider industry partners.

- I used prototyping and modelling to demonstrate opportunities to reduce release time **from 2 years to 3 months**.
- I introduced technologies for application management and isolation.
- I led the architecting of a cloud architecture to securely control public access to restricted networks.



Engineering Manager

1 year

[ZF TRW](#)

September 2016 – September 2017

I managed a team of engineers to create a safety case for an automotive radar and camera vision systems.

- We delivered safety cases for driving autonomy level 1 (hands on) applications.
- I trained **40 engineers** in safety management and Model Based Systems Engineering.

MBDA **System Architect**
[MBDA Systems](#)

7 years, 3 months
June 2009 – September 2016

I delivered a system architecture to take an ambitious future vision into reality.

- I drove alignment and **resolved critical project trade-offs** using a **new, data-driven model**.
- I commissioned user research and market analysis to **form consensus among critical stakeholders across multiple countries**, ensuring a shared vision for the product.
- I led a product team through the development of a novel autonomous system, using agile methodologies to strip back unnecessary requirements and deliver to an aggressive timeline.
- I worked closely with the Object Management Group to create and deliver an internal training path to certify engineers in Model Based Systems Engineering. **I trained more than 200 engineers** to accelerate the company's digital transformation.
- I led the development for and oversaw the delivery of a 6-week customer training exercise.

THALES **Software Engineer**
[Thales](#)

1 year, 9 months
September 2007 – June 2009

I worked in a team to rapidly deliver novel concepts, including prototypes for novel radar and tracking systems.

- We achieved **NATO security accreditation** for a Windows Server local network system.
- **I worked closely with our customer** to provide 8 weeks of support in Germany.

For more information, please see [my portfolio website](#).

Interests

Technology is a core part of my life. I passionately follow **AI advancements and their impact on society and industry**. I also like to hone my developer skills with personal projects, such as:

- Creating small cloud native websites such as [this one](#) to host my CV.
- Raspberry Pi projects, such as home automation systems and [Pi Holes](#).
- Creating Selenium scripts to automate repetitive admin tasks.

Aside from technology, I'm a keen amateur chef and love trying and recreating obscure diverse food from all over the planet. I'm also a **licensed Taekwondo instructor**.